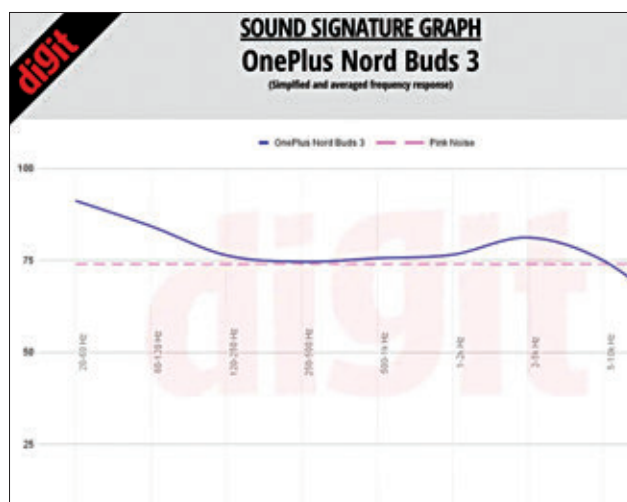




no in-ear detection, which is the only feature I found lacking on these buds.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus Nord Buds 3 has been designed with a strong focus on bass, which is evident as soon as you start playing bass-heavy tracks. Powered by 12.4 mm titanium-coated dynamic drivers, the earbuds produce deep lows, especially in genres like hip-hop, EDM, and pop. While some will enjoy this bass-forward sound signature, it is a bit too bloated to give an honest representation of the track it's playing. Furthermore, if you turn on OnePlus' BassWave algorithm it gets even more boomy.

The mid-range performance is balanced by itself, although it leans slightly towards warmth due to the bass emphasis. They can feel overshadowed by the strong bass response, particularly when listening to tracks where bass and vocals overlap. However, the earbuds still deliver a decent performance for podcasts, audiobooks, and tracks where vocals and instruments play a more prominent role.

The high frequencies, or treble, on the Nord Buds 3 are decent but not the most standout feature. Treble-focused instruments like cymbals, strings, or electronic high-pitched sounds are present but can feel somewhat recessed or less detailed compared to the bass. You can check the sound frequency graph to see the overemphasis of the bass

response, which is why it causes quite a bit of auditory masking, particularly in the mids. However, bass lovers will definitely enjoy the sonic response, but it's not for audiophiles and purists.

The microphone on these earbuds performs decently indoors but they face issues when used in a noisy, outdoor environment as they do not effectively cut out distracting sounds.

OnePlus needs to work on the microphone quality of future budget TWS as this is strictly mediocre.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life is one of the strongest aspects of the OnePlus Nord Buds 3. The 58mAh battery in each earbud provides up to 12 hours of playback without ANC, or 8 hours with ANC on. Our tests confirmed 7 hours and 15 minutes of usage with ANC turned on, at 60% volume, making the claim nearly accurate.

For phone calls, the battery lasts about 5 hours, primarily due to the energy demands of call noise cancellation. The charging case, with its 440mAh capacity, extends total playback time to 43 hours without ANC, and 28 hours with ANC enabled.

Impressively, the TÜV Rheinland Battery Health certification ensures that after 1,000 charging cycles, the battery will retain at least 80 per cent of its capacity.

Additionally, fast charging provides 11 hours of playback with just a

10-minute charge when ANC is off—a major convenience for users on the go.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Nord Buds 3 strikes an excellent balance between affordability and features. Priced at ₹2,299, it delivers decent ANC, excellent battery life, and an array of premium features. The addition of volume controls and dual-device connectivity makes it a more refined product than its predecessor, the Nord Buds 2. While the microphone quality is mediocre and some users might find the vocal quality lacking in clarity, the overall performance, especially at this price point, is impressive. If you're a budget-conscious consumer looking for bass-heavy audio with great battery life, the OnePlus Nord Buds 3 should be at the top of your list.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Colours: Harmonic Gray, Melodic White | Earbuds Weight: 4.2 g each | Drivers: 12.4 mm dynamic driver | Driver Sensitivity: 112dB ± 3dB | Frequency Response: 20 Hz - 20,000 Hz | Battery Life: ANC on - 8 hours (earbuds) / 28 hours (with charging case), ANC off - 12 hours (earbuds) / 43 hours (with charging case) | Fast Charging: Yes, 10 minutes for 11 hours (earbuds + case) | ANC: Up to 32 dB | IP Rating: IP55 | Bluetooth Version: 5.4 | Wireless Range: 10 m | Audio Codecs: AAC, SBC

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